Video Game Movies Are Entering a New Era

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If you went to a movie theater this year, there is a good chance the film on the big screen started as a video game. According to the source, The Super Mario Galaxy Movie drew families, Iron Lung became a surprise hit with horror fans, Resident Evil won praise, and even the heavily criticized Street Fighter found an audience as a light popcorn flick. The writer suggests 2026 might be remembered as a **landmark** year for video game movies.

Now that wave is growing. Studios are buying the **film rights** to games quickly, and this time many projects are moving forward with real plans. A24's Elden Ring film is a major example. Reports cited in the source say it has a $200 million **budget**, which would make it A24's most expensive film to date, and Amazon has secured exclusive streaming rights. Other **adaptations** with confirmed release dates through 2028 include The Legend of Zelda, Sonic the Hedgehog 4, Call of Duty, Helldivers, and a Minecraft sequel.

New announcements keep coming. Netflix is developing a **live-action** PUBG series, with Donald Glover attached to produce, write, direct, and star. Sony is working on an adaptation of Mouthwashing, to be directed by Karyn Kusama. On the **animation** side, there is a fresh look at Death Stranding Isolation, an anime coming to Disney Plus next year, and talk that news about a Bloodborne movie director could come soon.

Why now? Successful game films and shows, including Sonic the Hedgehog, A Minecraft Movie, The Last of Us, and Fallout, have shown that familiar game worlds can bring audiences and ready-made stories. At the same time, many rising filmmakers grew up with games and online video. Games, the writer argues, are now deeply woven into everyday culture.

Word Treasure

adaptations -- Films or shows made from an existing story, such as a video game.

landmark -- Very important or memorable in the history of something.

budget -- The amount of money planned or set aside to make something.

film rights -- The legal permission to turn a story or game into a movie.

live-action -- Filmed with real actors rather than drawn or computer-made characters.

animation -- Moving images made from drawings or computer models instead of live filming.

Background you need

A video game adaptation turns a game's world, characters and story into a film or television show.

Studios must buy the film rights to a game before they can make a movie from it, and big projects can take years to plan.

Earlier game films and shows such as Sonic the Hedgehog, A Minecraft Movie, The Last of Us and Fallout showed that familiar game worlds can attract large audiences.

Many rising filmmakers also grew up playing games, which is one reason so many game adaptations are now moving forward.

Break it down

LEAD: Video game movies are entering a new era, with many game-based films drawing audiences this year.

KEY EVENT: Studios are buying film rights quickly and many projects are moving forward with real plans.

+- BIG EXAMPLE: A24's Elden Ring film, reported to have a $200 million budget

+- MORE PROJECTS: Netflix's PUBG series, Sony's Mouthwashing, and a Death Stranding anime

EVIDENCE: Successful titles such as Sonic the Hedgehog, The Last of Us and Fallout showed game worlds can bring audiences and ready-made stories.

OPEN QUESTION: The writer suggests 2026 might be remembered as a landmark year for video game movies.

Why it matters

Games are now deeply woven into everyday culture, so their stories are reaching cinemas and streaming services, not just consoles. That means the games young people already know may shape much of what they watch next.

Test what you remember

1. **Which studio's Elden Ring film is given as a major example of the new wave?**
   - (A) Sony
   - (B) Amazon
   - (C) A24
   - (D) Netflix
2. **What budget is reported for the Elden Ring film?**
   - (A) $200 million, which would make it A24's most expensive film to date
   - (B) No budget is mentioned
   - (C) $50 million
   - (D) The same as a Minecraft sequel
3. **What is Netflix developing?**
   - (A) An Elden Ring film
   - (B) A Minecraft sequel
   - (C) A live-action PUBG series with Donald Glover attached to produce, write, direct and star
   - (D) A Bloodborne movie
4. **Who is set to direct Sony's adaptation of Mouthwashing?**
   - (A) No director is named
   - (B) A rising horror fan
   - (C) Karyn Kusama
   - (D) Donald Glover
5. **Which of these is listed among adaptations with confirmed release dates through 2028?**
   - (A) The Legend of Zelda
   - (B) PUBG
   - (C) Mouthwashing
   - (D) Bloodborne
6. **Why does the writer say game adaptations are growing now?**
   - (A) Movie theaters have closed
   - (B) Games have stopped being made
   - (C) Studios have run out of books
   - (D) Successful game films and shows proved familiar game worlds can bring audiences, and many rising filmmakers grew up with games

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. The writer: The writer suggests 2026 might be remembered as a landmark year for video game movies and argues that games are now deeply woven into everyday culture.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):